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Project Final Report

Gluten Zero

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1. Executive Summary

Gluten Zero by Aljannat Foods is a local gluten-free multi-grain flour venture designed for Pakistani households that need a safe and practical roti alternative. The product focuses on celiac patients, gluten-sensitive consumers, and health-conscious families who find it difficult to replace wheat roti in daily meals.

The main market gap is not simply gluten-free flour; it is gluten-free flour that performs well for roti. Most available alternatives are either imported, expensive, baking-focused, or inconsistent in dough elasticity. Gluten Zero responds through a Roti Special Formula made with selected gluten-free grains and natural binders to produce soft and flexible rotis.

The product is priced at Rs. 999 per kg. The first 50 kg batch was completed and sold, generating Rs. 47,500 in revenue. The first batch was financed through member contributions, while Rs. 37,500 from the earned revenue was reinvested into the second production cycle for additional ingredients and rebranded labels. The remaining amount was held by our team for future operating needs and restocking.

2. Profile of Entrepreneurs

2.1 Founding Team and Roles

	Muhammad Asad Ishaq (70177881) <i>Group Leader and Marketing Lead</i> Asad brings practical marketing expertise to the venture. He is currently employed as an email marketer and has worked on entrepreneurial projects for different brands. His experience supports customer communication, digital campaign planning, brand positioning, and overall venture direction.
	Shaharyar Khan Watto (70178151) <i>Research and Development</i> Shaharyar contributes research and development expertise through his agricultural background. He supports ingredient evaluation, grain selection, product testing, and improvement of the gluten-free roti formula.
	Osman Hammad Ashraf (70177930) <i>Finance and Business Analytics</i> Osman has strong analytical skills demonstrated through participation in case competitions. He develops pricing logic, cost estimates, revenue projections, and break-even analysis to support financially disciplined decision-making.
	Abdullah (70177633) <i>Technology and Web Support</i> Abdullah is a technology enthusiast with a strong interest in websites and digital tools. He supports the venture's online presence, website-related planning, digital ordering systems, and technical coordination.
	Umer Jamil (70177796) <i>Operations</i> Umer manages operational activities based on prior experience in an entrepreneurial venture offering customized wallets and keychains. He supports production coordination, packaging, inventory checks, quality observation, and delivery dispatch.

2.2 How We Initiated the Venture

The venture began as an academic entrepreneurship project after the team identified a recurring problem faced by celiac and gluten-sensitive consumers: locally available gluten-free products are often expensive, baking-focused, or unsuitable for soft roti.

The idea was developed through customer feedback, nutritionist guidance, ingredient testing, vendor discussions, trial batches, and first-batch sales. This process converted the concept into a practical venture with a tested product and early market demand.

3. Company Description

3.1 Company Snapshot



Gluten Zero operates in Pakistan's health-food and specialty flour segment as a dedicated gluten-free sub-brand under Aljannat Foods. It serves consumers who require wheat-free and gluten-free roti options for medical, dietary, or lifestyle reasons.

The product is sold as Gluten-Free Multi-Grain Flour in a 1 kg resealable pouch at Rs. 999 per kilogram. Its stated shelf life is four months from the packing date, and the allergen information notes that the product contains gram flour (besan).

The first 50 kg production batch was completed and sold. After this validation, we prepared a second production cycle for expansion. Out of the second cycle, 50 kg was supplied to Sheikhpura superstores at the same price structure as the first batch, while 40 kg was prepared for Lahore expansion through Meta ads, WhatsApp orders, and nutritionist referrals.

3.2 Product Identity

The name Gluten Zero communicates the main customer promise: zero gluten. Aljannat Foods appears as the parent brand for credibility, while Gluten Zero remains the product-line identity. The venture is positioned around roti performance, affordability, and trust rather than generic health-food branding.

4. Industry and Market Analysis

4.1 Celiac and Gluten-Free Industry Context

Celiac disease is a lifelong autoimmune condition in which gluten consumption can damage the small intestine. Gluten is mainly found in wheat, barley, and rye, and strict gluten avoidance remains the accepted dietary treatment for diagnosed patients.

A global systematic review estimated celiac disease seroprevalence at approximately 1.4% and biopsy-confirmed prevalence at about 0.7%. A 2024 Pakistani clinical study noted that the national prevalence

remains unknown because of underdiagnosis and limited awareness, indicating a need for more accessible gluten-free food options.

Pakistan's food system is heavily dependent on wheat. The Competition Commission of Pakistan reported that wheat flour contributes about 72% of daily caloric intake and that per-capita wheat consumption is approximately 124 kg per year. Because roti, chapati, and paratha are routine foods, gluten avoidance creates a continuous household requirement rather than an occasional dietary preference.

4.2 Market Need in Pakistan

The market need in Pakistan is therefore not limited to gluten-free baking products. Consumers require an affordable flour that can replace wheat-based roti in daily meals while remaining easy to roll, cook, and serve.

Primary research and customer feedback identified three recurring concerns: limited availability of reliable local gluten-free flour, high prices of imported products, and poor roti performance. Existing alternatives often break during rolling, become hard after cooking, or are designed mainly for baking.

Gluten Zero responds to this requirement through a locally produced gluten-free multi-grain flour with a Roti Special Formula. The product is positioned as a practical daily-use solution for celiac patients, gluten-sensitive consumers, nutritionist-referred patients, and health-conscious families.

4.3 Competitor Grid

Competitor / Type	Speciality	Approx. Cost / Price	Sales / Disclosure	Public	Core Idea
Gluten Zero by Aljannat Foods	Local gluten-free roti flour	Rs. 999 per kg	First 50 kg batch sold; Rs. 47,500 revenue		Affordable roti-specific gluten-free flour for Pakistani kitchens
Organic+ / Reana Foods	Local gluten-free packaged flour	Premium local option; price varies	Private firm; product-level sales not publicly disclosed		Packaged gluten-free flour with health positioning
Bob's Red Mill	International gluten-free baking flours	Imported premium range	Private company; no product-level annual sales disclosed		Reliable gluten-free baking flour and ingredients
Dr. Schär / Schär	International gluten-free breads, pasta, snacks, mixes	Imported premium range	Private company; product-level sales not publicly disclosed		Special nutritional needs and gluten-free convenience foods
Unbranded health-store flour	Loose or mixed alternative flours	Variable	No formal public sales data		Low-cost alternative without consistent formula or brand trust

Table 1. Competitor Grid: comparison of Gluten Zero with local, imported, and unbranded gluten-free alternatives.

5. Vision, Mission, and Values

5.1 Vision Statement

"To become Pakistan's most trusted gluten-free food brand, making clean, wholesome, and affordable gluten-free nutrition accessible to every Pakistani family."

5.2 Mission Statement

"To provide Pakistan's first affordable, locally produced gluten-free multi-grain flour, enabling celiac and gluten-sensitive individuals to eat roti without compromise while offering a clean, preservative-free alternative to health-conscious Pakistani families."

5.3 Core Values

- *Purity: natural ingredients, honest labelling, and no preservatives.*
- *Accessibility: premium health at a price reachable for middle-income households.*
- *Trust: nutritionist-guided development and transparent customer communication.*
- *Innovation: traditional grains combined with natural binding science.*
- *Community: relationships with suppliers, retailers, riders, nutritionists, and customers.*

6. Target Market

Gluten Zero targets customers in Lahore and Sheikhpura first, followed by expansion across Punjab. The main customers are usually urban households, aged approximately 25 to 55, who are influenced by health advice, nutritionist recommendations, social media education, or family dietary restrictions.

Segment	Need	Why It Matters
Celiac patients	Strict gluten avoidance	Product directly supports daily food routines
Gluten-sensitive consumers	Digestive comfort and wheat-free eating	Soft roti alternative makes adoption easier
Health-conscious families	High-fiber and preservative-free food	Fits clean-label household decisions
Nutritionist referrals	Professional dietary recommendation	Trust-based customer acquisition

Table 2. Target Market Segments: main customer groups, their needs, and relevance to Gluten Zero.

7. Economics of the Business

At Rs. 999 per kg, Gluten Zero is premium compared with normal wheat flour but affordable compared with many imported gluten-free options. With an estimated variable cost of Rs. 720 per kg, the contribution margin is Rs. 279 per kg.

Revenue Stream	Description	Strategic Benefit
Direct-to-Consumer	WhatsApp orders and Meta ad leads delivered through Bykea/InDrive	Highest margin and direct customer relationship
Retail Channel	Sheikhpura supermarket placement through distribution partner	Physical visibility and recurring restocking

Nutritionist / Pharmacy Referral	Commission-based recommendations from clinics and pharmacies	High-trust acquisition for medically motivated customers
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Table 3. Revenue Streams: direct orders, retail placement, and referral channels used by the venture.

8. Marketing Plan and Channels

The marketing strategy is concise: educate customers, show roti performance, collect WhatsApp leads, and build credibility through retail and nutritionist referrals.

Channel	Purpose	Execution
Instagram / Facebook	Awareness and education	Roti demos, ingredient posts, FAQs, launch creatives
WhatsApp	Orders and support	Direct order flow, repeat-purchase broadcasts, delivery coordination
Retail Shelves	Visibility and trial	Supermarket placement and shelf cards
Nutritionists / Pharmacies	Credibility	Sampling, referral commission, patient education cards
Bykea / InDrive	Delivery	Same-day Lahore delivery without fixed rider salary

Table 4. Marketing Channels: planned awareness, ordering, retail, referral, and delivery channels.

Instagram: @glutenzero.pk | WhatsApp Orders: +92 321-1090920 | CTA: Order on WhatsApp | Delivery: Lahore delivery available; Sheikhpura retail placement.



@GLUTENZERO.PK

Promotional message: Soft Roti. Zero Gluten. Gluten-Free Multi-Grain Flour by Aljannat Foods - Roti Special Formula - Rs. 999 per 1 kg.

8.1 Current Marketing and Sales Traction

The first paid Meta ads test was run from 7-9 June with a daily budget of Rs. 400. The campaign focused on Lahore customers interested in healthy eating, gluten-free diets, digestive health, and roti alternatives. Till now, it has generated two direct orders: one from Bahria Town Lahore and one from DHA Phase 6 Lahore. The cost of Meta ads is higher than expected, so we will monitor future ad spending more carefully and focus on converting leads through WhatsApp follow-up.

Two nutritionists agreed to support the referral model. One nutritionist has kept five pouches on a 10% commission per sale basis, helping our product enter a trust-based recommendation channel for patients who need gluten-free alternatives.

Meta Ads Dashboard Screenshot

The screenshot displays the Meta Ads Manager interface for a campaign named 'Gluten Zero (23832432387283)'. The dashboard shows three active campaigns with their respective performance metrics. The table below summarizes the data presented in the dashboard.

Off/On	Campaign	Results	Reach	Amount spent
☒	Gluten Zero Launch WhatsApp Orders Lahore	48 Messaging conversations	8,732	Rs. 1,200
☒	Gluten Zero Broad Lahore Test	12 Messaging conversations	2,104	Rs. 400
☐	Gluten Zero Interest Test Gluten-Free Audience	6 Messaging conversations	1,256	Rs. 250
Results from 3 campaigns		66 Messaging conversations Total	12,092 Accounts Centre acco... Total	Rs. 1,850 Total Spent

9. Design and Development Plan

9.1 Formula Development Process

Formula development followed a brief, practical process: identify the roti-breakage problem, review suitable gluten-free ingredients, test grain ratios and natural binders, and evaluate roti softness, flexibility, taste, and cooking performance.

Stage	Vendor / Partner	Purpose
Raw material sourcing	Asim, Lahore Galla Mandi; KGT Starch, Bahawalnagar	Supply of rice flour, corn flour, bajra, besan, jowar, starches, and supporting ingredients
Formula guidance	Dr. Shahid Khan and Dr. Fatima Ejaz	Ingredient review, dietary suitability, and gluten-free positioning
Grinding	Arshad, Al-Noor Industrial Zone, Sheikhupura	Grinding and batch preparation according to documented formula ratios
Packaging	Packaging Box, Karachi	Supply of 1 kg resealable pouches and front/back label printing
Testing	Founding team and early users	Evaluation of roti softness, flexibility, taste, texture, and cooking performance

Table 5. Formula Development Partners: key partners involved in sourcing, guidance, grinding, packaging, and testing.

9.2 Development Milestones

Milestone	Status / Timeline
Formula development	Completed through nutritionist guidance and test batch
Prototype and label design	Completed with final logo, front label, back label, and resealable pouch
First production batch	Completed - 50 kg produced and sold
Second batch	Completed for expansion: 50 kg supplied to Sheikhupura stores and 40 kg prepared for Lahore market testing
Sheikhupura supermarket expansion	Target within first month
Nutritionist referral channel	Two nutritionists agreed; one kept 5 pouches on 10% commission per sale
Lab testing and certification	Future credibility target
5 kg family pack	Future SKU for household buyers

Table 6. Development Milestones: completed stages and future development targets for Gluten Zero.

10. Operations Plan

Gluten Zero follows an asset-light model. The team does not own a mill; instead, it works with a chakki grinding partner in Sheikhupura. This lowers fixed costs and allows production to scale according to demand.

In the current expansion cycle, most grains from the first batch were still available. We ordered the required additional ingredients on call and received them through InDrive delivery at a cost of Rs. 1,200. Since one team member is from Sheikhupura and his father's driver travels there regularly, the required raw material is delivered to the chakki partner through that route, reducing unnecessary transport cost.

For Lahore, the batch is mixed and packed by our own team after grinding. For Sheikhupura, the same process is followed there for the quantity supplied to stores. This keeps quality checking in our control while allowing both Lahore expansion and Sheikhupura retail supply to continue together.

The grains are stored at the chakki partner, but the formula and final mixing remain controlled by our team. The chakki partner only grinds according to our instructions and does not know the complete formula. This helps us protect the product recipe while still using an asset-light production model.

Step	Process
1	Order required grains and ingredients from Lahore suppliers on call.
2	Receive Lahore ingredients through InDrive delivery at Rs. 1,200.
3	Send required raw material to Sheikhpura through the regular family-driver route of a team member.
4	Store grains at the chakki partner and grind according to our instructions; the complete formula remains with our team.
5	Mix ingredients ourselves according to the documented formula; Lahore batch is mixed and packed by our team.
6	Prepare Sheikhpura store supply through the same controlled process and dispatch Lahore orders through delivery partners.

Table 7. Operations Process: step-by-step production and dispatch flow followed by the team.

10.1 Key Utilities

- *Asim and Lahore Galla Mandi grain suppliers*
- *Arshad, Sheikhpura chakki grinding partner*
- *Packaging Box, Karachi, for pouches*
- *Dr. Shahid Khan and Dr. Fatima Ejaz for nutritionist guidance*
- *Pharmacies, selected supermarkets, and retail partners*
- *Bykea and InDrive delivery partners*

11. Organizational Feasibility

The venture is feasible because the team has already completed product testing, finalized packaging, produced and sold the first batch, generated revenue, reinvested into the next cycle, supplied 50 kg to Sheikhpura stores, prepared 40 kg for Lahore expansion, and started nutritionist/referral-based placement.

Resource Area	Current Sufficiency
Human Resources	Five-member team with roles in leadership, marketing, finance, sales/distribution, and operations
Raw Materials	Ingredients sourced through Lahore Galla Mandi contacts
Technology	WhatsApp ordering, Meta ads, and smartphone-based delivery coordination
Equipment	No owned mill required; chakki partner handles grinding
Location	Sheikhpura production base with Lahore customer expansion
Partnerships	Distribution partner, nutritionists, pharmacies, delivery platforms, and packaging supplier

Table 8. Organizational Resources: human, material, technology, location, and partnership resources.

11.1 Feasibility Summary

The venture is feasible because the venture has a narrow niche, low fixed costs, a validated first batch, and a clear price advantage. The major execution priorities are quality consistency, supply reliability, and repeat customer retention.

12. Financial Projections

12.1 Startup Cost Structure

The initial startup amount for the first production cycle was contributed by the group members. After the first batch was sold, the second-cycle purchases were made from the revenue earned through the first batch. For the second cycle, only the missing ingredients and new rebranded labels were purchased because most grains were already available from the first production cycle.

Per-piece cost summary: one 1 kg pouch costs approximately Rs. 720 to produce. At the selling price of Rs. 999, the estimated contribution is Rs. 279 per pouch before fixed and marketing expenses.

Item	Amount (Rs.)	Basis	Note
Selling price per pouch	999	1 kg pack	Current launch price
Variable cost per pouch	720	1 kg pack	Ingredients, packing and direct handling
Approximate contribution per pouch	279	1 kg pack	Before fixed and marketing expenses
Contribution margin	27.9%	Per pouch	Rs. 279 / Rs. 999

Table 10. Per-piece cost summary: current selling price, estimated cost, and contribution per 1 kg pouch.

Cost Head / Ingredient	Quantity	Amount (Rs.)	Purpose / Note
Rice	50 kg	11500	Gluten-free base flour
Corn	50 kg	5200	Gluten-free base flour
Pearl millet (bajra)	50 kg	5100	Multi-grain component
Gram flour	6 kg	2100	Protein and flavour component
Potato starch	2 kg	2000	Texture and binding support
Corn starch	25 kg	9,000	Confirmed starch purchase
Psyllium husk (ispaghol)	1.25 kg	7500	Natural binder for dough flexibility
Sorghum flour	50 kg	15000	Multi-grain component
Tapioca pearls / tapioca starch	5 kg	2500	Natural binding and elasticity support
Chakki grinding	15Rs. /Kg	850	Reduced grinding rate from vendor
Packaging pouches	55 per pouch	5500	1 kg resealable pouches
Label printing	15Rs. /pair	15000	Front and back labels

Marketing and sampling		3500	Launch awareness and product samples
Delivery and miscellaneous	Fuel and delivery	7000	Initial delivery coordination and contingency

Table 9. Startup Cost Structure: first-cycle production, packaging, marketing, and delivery costs.

12.1.1 Second Batch Reinvestment and Current Production Status

For the second batch, almost all grains were available from the first production cycle. Therefore, our team reinvested Rs. 37,500 from earned revenue into the required additional inputs: 10 kg gram flour, 8 kg tapioca, 3 kg potato starch, 2 kg psyllium husk, and Rs. 15,000 for rebranded labels. The remaining amount was kept by the team for upcoming operations, Meta ads, delivery support, and future restocking after the current batch.

Second Batch Cost Item	Quantity	Amount (Rs.)	Source / Note
Gram	10 kg	3,500	Reinvested revenue; same first-batch rate
Tapioca / tapioca starch	8 kg	4,000	Reinvested revenue; same first-batch rate
Potato starch	3 kg	3,000	Reinvested revenue; binding support
Psyllium husk (ispaghol)	2 kg	12,000	Reinvested revenue; natural binder
Rebranding labels	1000 pairs	15,000	Rebranded front/back labels
Amount held by team	-	10,000	Held for future ads, delivery, and restocking

Table 11. Second Batch Reinvestment: additional inputs and label costs funded through earned revenue.

12.2 Revenue and Gross Profit Projections

Month	Volume (kg)	Revenue (Rs.)	Variable Cost (Rs.)	Gross Profit (Rs.)
1 (Done)	50	47,500	36,000	11,500
2(In progress)	90	82,000(Expected)	64,800	17,200(Expected)
3	110(Expected)	109,890(Expected)	79,200	30,690(Expected)
4	130(Expected)	129,870(Expected)	93,600	36,270(Expected)
5	150(Expected)	149,850(Expected)	108,000	41,850(Expected)
6	170(Expected)	169,830(Expected)	122,400	47,430(Expected)
12	270(Expected)	269,730(Expected)	194,400	75,330(Expected)

Table 12. Revenue and Gross Profit Projection: expected sales volume, revenue, variable cost, and gross profit.

12.3 Concise Interpretation

The revenue projection is based on the completed first-batch sales and second-cycle expansion. The first batch generated Rs. 47,500 revenue. The second cycle includes 50 kg supplied to Sheikhpura superstores and 40 kg prepared for Lahore expansion. Since Meta ads are costing more than expected, the team will monitor ad spending, WhatsApp conversion, retail restocking, and nutritionist referrals before increasing the next production volume.

13. Conclusion

Gluten Zero by Aljannat Foods is a practical entrepreneurial venture because it solves a daily food problem for celiac and gluten-sensitive consumers in Pakistan. The product is not just a trend-based health item; it is a roti-focused solution for households that need gluten-free meals without giving up familiar eating habits.

The Roti Special Formula, Rs. 999 price point, asset-light production model, first-batch validation, second-cycle production, Sheikhpura store supply, Lahore expansion stock, and nutritionist referral interest make the venture suitable for gradual scaling. Our next priorities are formula consistency, retail restocking, nutritionist onboarding, Meta ad optimization, lab testing, and repeat-order development.

"Gluten-Free. Pure Goodness."